

long it would take for a reply to be forthcoming. Low activity newsgroups are not the best places to expect a prompt response.

8.2.2 The Sites

Next, we shall look at some notable tech help sites.

Official Sites

If the question is product specific and if the product is in warranty, it is better to approach the manufacturer directly for assistance. Most manufacturers have a customer support crew to handle such queries. For manufacturer-specific tech help, visit the home page and search for any link labelled “Support”. Almost all hardware and software manufacturers with a Web site include a forum, where users can exchange views. Please note, this does not refer to the official support Web sites where the company’s support team answers queries.

Major software vendors such as Microsoft (e.g., Visual Studio), Sun (e.g., Java), Oracle (e.g., Oracle RDBMS) and Adobe (e.g., Photoshop) have their own support forums at forums.microsoft.com, forum.java.sun.com, forums.oracle.com, adobeforums.com, respectively. Hardware manufacturers such as ASUS, NVIDIA, and Apple also have their own forums at vip.asus.com/forum/, forums.nvidia.com, discussions.apple.com, respectively.

Techguy.org (helponte.net)

Numbers speak loudest—6,44,000+ posts under the hardware sub forum and 6,94,00+ posts under Windows OS sub forum. There are quite a few ads, but most of them are text based. Besides these two sub forums, there are others that cater to Malware/Spyware removal (7,50,000 posts), General Software, Linux/Unix and Games. The fall out for this site is the comparatively limited posts in the non-Windows OS and software development sub forums. However, at



The Tech Support Guy!